

Consumer Behaviour — Connected Revision Sheet

Mid-Term · the whole syllabus as one wired system, not loose facts. Read the spine first — every theory hangs off it. **Purple = who proposed it.**

0 The Master Spine: S → O → R (everything hangs here)

STIMULUS (what the firm controls: 4Ps + socio-cultural cues) → **ORGANISM** (the black box: *Motivation* → *Perception* → *Learning/Memory* → *Personality/Self* → *Attitude*, all bent by *behavioural biases*) → **RESPONSE** (Purchase → Post-purchase evaluation → loyalty or dissonance).

Schiffman calls the same thing **Input** → **Process** → **Output**. The marketer loads the Stimulus; the sale is manufactured inside the Organism. Every chapter below is a component *inside the O*.

The decision is a LOOP, not a line: Stimulus → System 1/2 thinking → a bias fires → evoked-set evaluation → Purchase → Post-purchase (satisfaction / dissonance) → *feeds memory* → shapes the *next* decision. Draw this and you can open almost any 10-mark answer.

1 WHY they act — Motivation the engine

Motivation = driving force from **tension** in an unfulfilled need. **Process:** Need → Tension → Drive → Behaviour → Goal (satisfaction) → *feeds learning*. Tension (not satisfaction) drives behaviour.

Theory (who)	Answers	One-line + hook
Maslow Maslow	What people need	Physiological → Safety → Social → Ego → Self-actualisation (prepotency). "Please Stop Selling Every Second."
SDT Deci & Ryan	Why motivated	Autonomy + Competence + Relatedness → intrinsic motivation (Nike, Duolingo).
Regulatory Focus Higgins	How goals pursued	Promotion (gains/ideals) vs Prevention (safety/oughts) → <i>parent of gain- vs loss-framing</i> .
Herzberg 2-factor	Dissatisfy vs delight	Hygiene (prevent dissatisfaction) vs Motivators (create delight). Today's motivator → tomorrow's hygiene.
Means-End / Laddering	Feature → value	Attributes → Consequences → Values. Ask "why important?" (airbag → protection → family safety).

Links out: Regulatory Focus → framing (Ch4/biases). Means-End → positioning & Live Brand Diagnosis. Herzberg → the disconfirmation case (fix hygiene first).

2 HOW they read the world — Perception the interpreter

Perception = select → organise → interpret stimuli into a subjective picture. *Not reality — how consumers interpret reality.*

Process: **Stimulus** → (**selective**) **Attention** → **Gestalt organisation** → **Interpretation** → **Perception** → **decision**.

Thresholds: *Absolute* = detect something vs nothing (→ sensory adaptation, why ads refresh). *Differential* = JND.

Weber's Law (Weber): $\Delta I / I = \text{constant}$ — bigger base, bigger change needed. Use: hide bad changes **below** JND (shrinkflation), show improvements **at/above** JND; logo redesigns stay below JND.

Gestalt: Figure-ground · Grouping · Closure (mind completes it → involvement).

Imagery: Positioning → Perceptual map (find the gap) · perceived price vs perceived quality · extrinsic cues → *signalling* · perceived risk → risk-reduction (reviews, trials, warranties).

Links out: perception feeds Learning & Attitude; extrinsic cues → signalling (Self, Ch6); anchoring/decoy live where price is perceived.

3 HOW it sticks — Learning, Memory & Brand Equity the recorder

Learning elements: Motivation, Cues, Response, Reinforcement. Two families:

Behavioural	Mechanism & use
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Classical conditioning Pavlov	Association: US → UR, pair NS+US → CS → CR. Apps: repetition (wear-out), generalisation (extensions/family brand/me-too), discrimination (positioning).
Operant/Instrumental Skinner	Consequence: +/- reinforcement (both ↑ behaviour), +/- punishment (↓). Schedules (variable-ratio = most addictive), shaping, massed vs distributed.
Habit Loop Duhigg	Cue → Craving → Response → Reward (Netflix weekend habit).
Observational Bandura	Learn by watching others + social proof (testimonials, reviews).

Cognitive / Memory (multi-store): Sensory → (attention) → Short-term/working (~4–5 items) → (rehearsal) → Long-term. **Encode** → **Store** → **Retrieve**; retrieval cues (logo, jingle, smell) are the target; interference & decay cause forgetting. **Levels of processing** (deep = personal/emotional = best recall); **Mere Exposure (Zajonc)** = see it more → like it more. **Brand equity (payoff): Aaker** = awareness, perceived quality, associations, loyalty, proprietary assets. **Keller CBBE pyramid:** Salience → Performance/Imagery → Judgements/Feelings → **Resonance** (loyalty). Hook: “**Silly People Judge Rockstars.**”

Links out: retrieval cue = the perceptual stimulus that re-fires the brand; reinforced experience → loyalty → equity; memory residue *becomes* the attitude (Ch9).

4 WHO they are — Personality & Self the filter

Personality = inner traits; consistent, enduring, can change. Segmentation base.

Freud (Freud): **Id** (impulse, ≈System 1) · **Superego** (conscience) · **Ego** (mediator, ≈System 2). Possessions extend the self.

Neo-Freud — Horney CAD: Compliant (toward), Aggressive (against), Detached (away).

Trait theory: innovativeness, dogmatism, social character (inner/other-directed), materialism, **ethnocentrism** (CETSCALE → “vocal for local”).

Brand personality Aaker: Sincerity, Excitement, Competence, Sophistication, Ruggedness.

Self-image: Actual / Ideal / Social / Ideal-social. **Signalling** = consumption communicates identity; **psychological ownership** (≈ endowment) → free trials convert.

5 The settled verdict — Attitudes the output

Attitude = learned predisposition to respond favourably/unfavourably. Learned, motivational, consistent-not-permanent.

Model (who)	Structure
Tri-component / ABC	Cognitive (Think/beliefs) + Affective (Feel/emotion) + Conative (Do/intention). High-involve: Think → Feel → Do; low: Do → Feel → Think.
Theory of Planned Behaviour Ajzen	Attitude + Subjective norms + Perceived Behavioural Control → Intention → Behaviour. PBC (over TRA) explains the want-vs-do gap.
Multi-attribute Fishbein	$A_0 = \sum (\text{Importance} \times \text{Belief})$. Change belief / add attribute / shift weights.
ELM Petty & Cacioppo	Central route (facts, durable) vs Peripheral (cues, fragile).
Cognitive dissonance Festinger	Post-purchase discomfort → reduce: seek + reviews, ignore negatives, justify, return. Marketer reassures.

Attitude vs Perception: attitude = enduring overall evaluation (beliefs+emotion+experience); perception = momentary interpretation of stimuli. *Attitude endures, perception shifts.*

6 The bias layer (behavioural economics, bends every stage)

Bias (who)	What & where it plugs in
System 1 / 2 Kahneman	Fast/intuitive vs slow/deliberate. Short stimulus–response gap = System 1 = impulse.
Framing	Same facts, different wording (“90% fat-free”; “buy 2 get 1”=33% off). Perception + Reg-Focus.
Anchoring / Decoy	

	First number sets reference; inferior 3rd option steers choice (popcorn, The Economist).
Endowment	Own it → value it more (trials, test drives) ≈ psychological ownership.
Prospect Theory Kahneman & Tversky	Value is <i>relative to a reference</i> ; loss aversion (losses hurt ~2×); diminishing sensitivity.
Bounded rationality Simon	Satisfice = good enough, not best.
Nudging / Choice architecture Thaler & Sunstein	Design defaults → steer without removing choice.

7 Formulas & tools you can be tested on

Multi-attribute (Fishbein): Attitude = $\sum (\text{Importance}_i \times \text{Belief/Rating}_i)$. Best single lever = highest **Importance × gap**.

Weber's Law / JND: $\Delta I / I = k$. Hide negatives below JND; flag improvements at/just above.

Customer Value: Total Benefits (functional+emotional+social) – Total Costs (price+time+effort). (or benefits ÷ costs.)

Prospect value: loss impact ≈ 2 × equal gain → frame with loss (“don’t miss out”).

Case toolkits: Live Brand Diagnosis (CJVEP) = Consumer Journey → Journey touchpoints → Value → Positioning → Equity. **IPA quadrant** (Importance×Performance): concentrate / keep up / low-priority / overkill. **Qualitative coding:** codes → categories → themes → insight.

8 Master comparison sheet (the exam traps)

Pair	The one-line distinction
System 1 vs 2	Fast/emotional/efficient vs slow/logical/effortful (not “irrational vs rational”).
Classical vs Operant	Learn by association (passive) vs by consequence/reward (active).
+ve vs -ve reinforcement	Add reward vs remove nuisance — both increase behaviour (≠ punishment).
Generalisation vs Discrimination	Same response to similar (extensions) vs distinguishing your brand (positioning).
Anchoring vs Framing vs Decoy	Reference number vs wording vs inferior 3rd option.
Hygiene vs Motivator	Prevent dissatisfaction vs create delight (independent, not one scale).
Absolute vs Differential threshold	Something/nothing vs a change (JND).
Promotion vs Prevention focus	Chase gains/ideals vs avoid loss/oughts.
TRA vs TPB	TPB adds Perceived Behavioural Control (explains intention–behaviour gap).
Cognitive/Affective/Conative	Think / Feel / intend-to-Do (conative = intention, not the act).
Attitude vs Perception	Enduring evaluation vs momentary interpretation.
Aaker vs Keller equity	5 assets vs 4-step pyramid.
Signalling vs Psychological ownership	Communicate identity outward vs feeling of “mine”.

9 The four integrated chains (memorise — they answer case questions)

1. **Positioning check:** reviews → code (codes → categories → theme) → net sentiment → map vs intended pillars → perceived price–value gap → reposition.

2. **Loyalty engine:** Cue (perception) → learning (classical + operant) → memory/retrieval cue → reinforced experience → habit → loyalty → brand equity (CBBE resonance).

3. **Attitude** → **action**: Perception → Learning/Memory → Attitude (ABC) → Intention (TPB: attitude+norm+PBC) → Behaviour → Post-purchase → dissonance → attitude revision.

4. **Checkout nudge stack**: “Bestseller” (social proof) + “was → now” (anchor/prospect) + “only 3 left” (scarcity/loss aversion) + “Recommended” default (bounded rationality/nudge) → System-1 purchase.

Last-minute hooks: Maslow “**Please Stop Selling Every Second.**” · SDT **A-C-R.** · Learning **M-C-R-R.** · Classical **US → UR, CS → CR.** · Habit **Cue-Crave-Respond-Reward.** · CBBE “**Silly People Judge Rockstars.**” · Freud **Id-impulse, Ego-evaluate, Superego-stop.** · Horney **Come-Attack-Detach.** · Aaker brand **S-E-C-S-R.** · Attitude **ABC = Feel-Do-Think.** · TPB **A-S-P → I → B.** · Prospect “**losses hurt twice.**”